COVID-19 INTERIM DECISION GUIDE FOR CHILD CARE OPERATORS TO DIRECT COHORTS TO SELF-ISOLATE

Updated September 17th, 2021

This tool is to be used by Child Care Operators to assist them in making a decision to dismiss a case's cohort(s) for self-isolation while awaiting the results of the Toronto Public Health (TPH) Investigation. TPH will investigate all positive cases related to a child care and notify their close contacts in a child care through a letter. The Communicable Disease Investigator (CDI) will contact the Child Care Operator and advise of next steps. If the Child Care Operator has any questions while they await for the CDI to contact them, they can contact the TPH COVID-19 Hotline by email at publichealth@toronto.ca or by calling 416-338-7600.

Operators informed of a positive COVID-19 case or symptomatic student/staff

Staff/student has symptoms but no laboratory result

Follow Child Care Settings protocols and COVID-19 Decision Tool for Child Care Attendees and Staff.

Laboratory confirmed positive for COVID-19

Report to Toronto Public Health
TPH COVID-19 Notification Form for Child Care Settings

***Please Note:**

- Child Care Operators will not ask other staff or children potentially exposed to the positive case outside of the cohort(s) to self-isolate. They will await direction from the TPH CDI. If an individual is symptomatic or a close contact of a positive case, then follow the child care settings protocols and the COVID-19 Decision Tool for Child Care Attendees and Staff.
- If the individual with COVID-19 interacts with multiple cohorts or visits many child care settings/cohort(s), the Child Care Operator will flag this for TPH and await the direction of the TPH CDI.
- The Child Care Operator should maintain a list of COVID-19 vaccination information of staff/child. This should be voluntarily disclosed by the child's parent/guardian. Collection of staff vaccination information should follow child care policy. This list is confidential and the Child Care Operator or designate should only use this information as required to dismiss children/staff that are part of affected cohorts who are not fully vaccinated with a COVID-19 vaccine*. Children/staff who are fully vaccinated with a COVID-19 vaccine and do not have a symptom(s) of COVID-19, do not need to be dismissed unless directed otherwise by TPH. TPH will complete an investigation of the case and their cohorts. Return to child care of individuals may be permitted at the discretion of the TPH CDI based on assessment of the investigation. Individuals who were previously positive for COVID-19 in the last 90 days or less and have been cleared by public health may be permitted to return to child care. TPH will provide this direction to these previously positive for COVID-19 close contacts.
- *Fully vaccinated is defined as an individual ≥14 days after receiving their second dose of a two-dose COVID-19 vaccine series or a single dose of a one-dose COVID-19 vaccine series.

Dismiss members of case's cohort(s) for self-isolation who have not been fully vaccinated with a COVID-19 vaccine*, until the Child Care Operator receives further direction from the TPH CDI. The case's siblings and household members who are not fully vaccinated* with a COVID-19 vaccine, also need to stay home.

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